BTC 8-Hour Market Report

Thursday 22 Oct 2026, 15:50 Malaysia time (07:50 UTC)

BTC ~ $82,700

CoinDesk, 24h +0.04%, range $82.6k-$84.8k

Quick view	**Bias:** Neutral, range-bound (slight upside lean on ETF inflows)	**Next 24h:** $81,000 - $84,300	**Key floor:** $80,000 / $79,700 (tested 3x)	**Big event:** Weekly expiry Fri 23 Oct 4:00pm MYT (~$1.2B, max pain ~$82k)

1. Options - next 24 hours and upcoming expiries

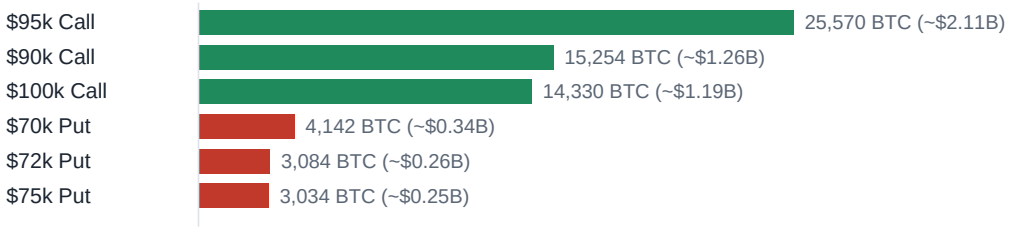
- Today's daily expiry (22OCT26) settles at **4:00pm MYT**, minutes after this report; it is small. The one that matters inside 24h is the **weekly 23OCT26 at Fri 4:00pm MYT**.
- Weekly 23 Oct is modest: about **14,759 BTC (~$1.2B notional)**, max pain **~$82,000** - right on spot. Its open interest leans to puts (P/C 1.24 on 16 Oct), with largest put strikes at $78k, $70k and $80k.
- The expiry that really matters is the **monthly 30 Oct**: ~149,000 BTC (~$12.3B), call-heavy (P/C 0.52), max pain $79,000, with a giant $95k call wall.

Expiry	Largest position seen	Size	Meaning
23 Oct weekly (put)	$78,000 put (largest put OI)	Size not published; total expiry ~14,759 BTC (~$1.2B)	Hedges sit below $80k; matter only if BTC breaks $80k before Friday 4pm MYT
23 Oct weekly (call)	Not published this run	n/a	Max pain $82k at spot = small pin effect into settlement; low impact either way
30 Oct monthly (call)	$95,000 call	25,570 BTC (~$2.11B)	Far out of the money; upside cap / sell-the-rally zone only if BTC rallies past $87k
30 Oct monthly (put)	$70,000 put	4,142 BTC (~$0.34B)	Tail hedge; puts are thin, downside is not heavily protected

Upcoming expiries

Expiry (Malaysia time)	Notional	Put/Call	Max pain	Largest strikes
Thu 22 Oct 4:00pm (daily)	Small (daily)	n/a	n/a	Settling now; negligible
Fri 23 Oct 4:00pm (weekly)	~$1.2B (14,759 BTC)	1.24 (16 Oct)	~$82,000	Puts $78k, $70k, $80k
Fri 30 Oct 4:00pm (monthly)	~$12.3B (~149k BTC)	0.52	$79,000	Calls $95k 25,570 / $90k 15,254 / $100k 14,330; Puts $70k 4,142 / $72k 3,084 / $75k 3,034
Fri 25 Dec 4:00pm (quarterly)	~$10B (30 Sep)	n/a	~$75,000 (Deribit)	Not published

30 Oct 2026 monthly expiry - largest Deribit open interest by strike (BTC, ~USD at $82.7k)



How options affect the market now

- **Pin into Friday:** weekly max pain (~$82k) sits on spot, so dealer hedging should keep BTC near $81k-$84k into Fri 4pm MYT. A weak magnet, not a wall - the expiry is only ~$1.2B.
- **Monthly pull lower:** 30 Oct max pain is $79k, about $3.7k below spot. Most of the $12B book is out-of-the-money calls that expire worthless below $90k, so call sellers have no reason to support a rally.
- **Upside acceleration only above $85k-$87k:** liquidation clusters sit above $84k and near $87k. A clean break of $84.3k could squeeze shorts into the $87k area, where call gamma ($90k/$95k) starts to slow it.

- **Downside is thinly hedged:** puts are small (largest $70k at 4,142 BTC) and fewer than 5% of puts are above $84k. A drop below $79.7k could be fast because there is little put-dealer buying until $75k-$70k.
- **Sentiment:** overall P/C ~0.70 (CryptoBriefing) and monthly 0.52 = call-heavy, mildly bullish positioning; but put skew premium (~16 pts per Au79) shows traders still pay up for crash protection.
- **Volatility:** ATM implied vol ~35% vs realised ~25%. Implied daily move ~1.8% (~$1,500). Expect vol to stay soft after Friday, then pick up into the FOMC (29 Oct MYT) and monthly expiry.

Data note: the Deribit public API (book summary and DVOL) was not reachable from this run, so strike sizes come from published reports (CryptoTicker 17 Oct, TokenPost 16 Oct, Invezz 22 Oct, Au79 21 Oct) - treat as "largest seen". USD sizes = BTC OI x $82,700.

2. Price action and key levels

- BTC pushed toward **$84,800** on Wednesday (21 Oct) but failed below $85k and fell back to ~**$82,700** as Tesla and Meta earnings did not ease AI-spending worries.
- 24h range $82,567 - $84,808 (CoinGecko via Crypto Times); 24h change roughly flat (+0.04% CoinDesk).
- Structure: a $79.7k - $84.3k range for most of October. $79,676 has held three times; $84,261 is the sell wall that capped the rally.
- 4h momentum neutral (RSI 56, MACD flat per Invezz). Long/short ratio ~1.01 - no crowding either way.

Type	Level	Why it matters
Resistance 2	$87,000	Liquidation cluster and start of $90k/$95k call gamma zone
Resistance 1	$84,300 - $85,000	Sell wall ($84,261), Wednesday's failed high $84,808
Pivot	$82,000 - $82,700	Weekly max pain and current spot; bias flips on a 4h close either side
Support	$80,000 / $79,700	Round number and triple-tested low ($79,676); monthly max pain $79k just below
Deep risk	$75,000 - $72,000	Next put OI cluster; thin hedging in between could make a break fast

3. Derivatives, flows and sentiment

Metric	Latest	Read
Futures open interest	$53.7B (Coinglass via Invezz, 22 Oct)	Up ~4% from 12 Oct low; leverage rebuilding but not extreme
Funding (8h)	+0.0079% (21 Oct)	Slightly positive, near neutral - no long overcrowding
Liquidations 24h	BTC $49M; all crypto $241M (20-21 Oct)	Quiet; earlier this week >$200M shorts liquidated on the push up
Spot BTC ETF flows	Mon 19 Oct +$527M; Tue 20 Oct ~+$23M; Wed 21 Oct ~+$528M	~$1.08B in 3 days; largest daily inflow since 22 Sep - supportive dip demand
Implied vol (ATM)	~35% (realised ~25%)	DVOL feed not reachable; implied daily move ~1.8% (~$1,500)
Fear and Greed	Alternative.me 44 (Fear) / CoinGecko 48 (21 Oct)	Neutral-to-cautious; room for upside if catalysts appear

4. News and macro

- **Big Tech earnings:** Tesla and Meta results did not calm AI capex worries; BTC slipped from its push toward $85k (CoinDesk, 22 Oct).
- **ETF demand:** ~$1.08B net inflows over three sessions this week; analysts question whether it is enough to fuel a sharp rally (CoinDesk/Invezz).
- **Tesla-SpaceX:** Musk said committees are evaluating a combination; together they hold ~30,221 BTC (~$2.5B). Preliminary, no terms.

- **Fed:** FOMC 27-28 Oct; Reuters poll 94/100 expect a hold at 3.75%-4.00%, all expect a December hike. Futures price under 20% odds of an October hike after Chair Warsh signalled a hold.
- **Geopolitics:** Middle East tension persists - Iran denies talk progress, a drone attack hit a Saudi oil field, US sends another carrier while cutting troop numbers.
- **Regulation:** OCC finalised GENIUS Act stablecoin rules (effective 18 Jan 2027); FINMA approved Switzerland's first retail spot Bitcoin ETF.

Event calendar (Malaysia time)

When (MYT)	Event
Thu 22 Oct 8:30pm	US initial jobless claims
Fri 23 Oct 4:30am	Fed H.4.1 balance sheet
Fri 23 Oct 4:00pm	Deribit weekly BTC options expiry (~$1.2B, max pain ~$82k)
Fri 23 Oct 9:45pm / 10:00pm	US S&P Global PMIs (Oct) / Michigan inflation expectations
Thu 29 Oct 2:00am / 2:30am	FOMC decision / Chair Warsh press conference (hold expected)
Thu 29 Oct 8:30pm	US September PCE inflation
Fri 30 Oct 4:00pm	Deribit MONTHLY expiry (~$12.3B, max pain $79k)
Fri 6 Nov 9:30pm	US October nonfarm payrolls
Tue 10 Nov 9:30pm	US October CPI

5. Summary and prediction

BTC is stuck in its October range after another rejection near $84.8k. ETF buyers are absorbing dips (~$1.08B in three days), funding is neutral and leverage is moderate, so the floor at $79.7k-$80k looks solid for now. Options add little push in the next 24h: the Friday weekly is small and its max pain (~$82k) sits on spot, which favours chop. The bigger forces arrive next week - the FOMC (29 Oct MYT) and the $12B monthly expiry with max pain at $79k - which slightly tilts risk lower into month-end unless BTC can close above $84.3k. **24h call: range $81,000-$84,300, pinned near $82k into Friday's 4pm MYT expiry; neutral bias.**

Scenario	Chance	Range	Trigger
Base: range/pin	55%	$81,000 - $84,300	Weekly max pain pin at $82k; quiet US data; ETF flows steady
Bullish breakout	25%	$84,300 - $87,000	4h close above $84,300 with strong ETF inflows; short squeeze toward $87k liquidations
Bearish break	20%	$79,000 - $81,000	Loss of $81.5k on risk-off (tech weakness, Middle East); pull toward $79k monthly max pain

- Bull signal: 4h close above **$84,300** with rising open interest and positive ETF flow = range break toward $87k.
- Bear signal: 4h close below **$80,000** = test of $79.7k / $79k; a break there opens $75k with little put support.
- Next report: 11:50pm MYT (Thu 22 Oct)

Sources

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